

offline and on the network.

Document profiling: All Document Management Systems allow you to save additional information so that it becomes easier to locate the documents later. When saving to the normal file system, you can specify a file name and a folder in a hierarchy. The system itself saves the date and time, file size and other attributes. A system profile extends this to allow a larger number of different attributes to be used, and does not force you to use a hierarchical system.

Generally, systems allow a single profile template for all documents. (Most systems actually allow you to create separate templates for different libraries of documents, but this normally requires you to create a very hard division in the filing system). Documents in real life do not lend themselves to such neat classification, especially if you are looking to file all documents, both client-related and internal. If you have a large profile, people will be less likely to fill it in and find it harder and slower to use. With a small profile, you lose many of the benefits of having a DMS in the first place.

Version control: Almost all systems provide for documents to be checked out, updated and returned to the system as a new version. The DMS makes sure that only one person at a time is working on a document and that the latest version is always known.

Systems would generally require customisation and additional work to meet company requirements.

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can narrow down the visible documents on the tree by using the filters that are located in the upper right corner of the window.

Most operations (such as opening, copying, deleting, editing profiles, adding to favourites, listing existing versions, adding new versions, printing, searching and previewing) can be performed on the workbench. You can open a document by just double-clicking on it. When you select a document on the tree, its profile details are revealed on the right side of the window.

There are other commands that give you more freedom over the security of your data:

Save As...: Use this to save a document outside the QDocs database system. This option will prompt you for a path and file name. A document saved thus, cannot be retrieved by QDocs—you will have to retrieve it manually.

Remove Password from Document: Use this option to remove the password from the current document so that others can use it.

Set New Password to Document: Use this option to set a new password to your current document for more security.

The last words

QDocs also works in a multi-user environment and does not require an expensive server—a normal PC can act as your file server. It also does not require a big relational database such as SQL-Server or Oracle. QDocs is built specifically for the small to mid-sized companies.

You must note that QDocs is compiled for Microsoft Office 2000 and works with Office XP. However, in some computers running Office 97, it crashes when you try to open a document within QDocs, or shows the message 'compile error' while attempting to save. To amend this, ask for an Office 97 compiled version.

To disable QDocs go to **Start > Programs > QDocs > Stop QDocs**. Note that MS-Word must be closed while you do this. Alternatively, when you are ready to save your document, keep the Shift key pressed and click on the Save Button. This will open the Word Save window instead. 